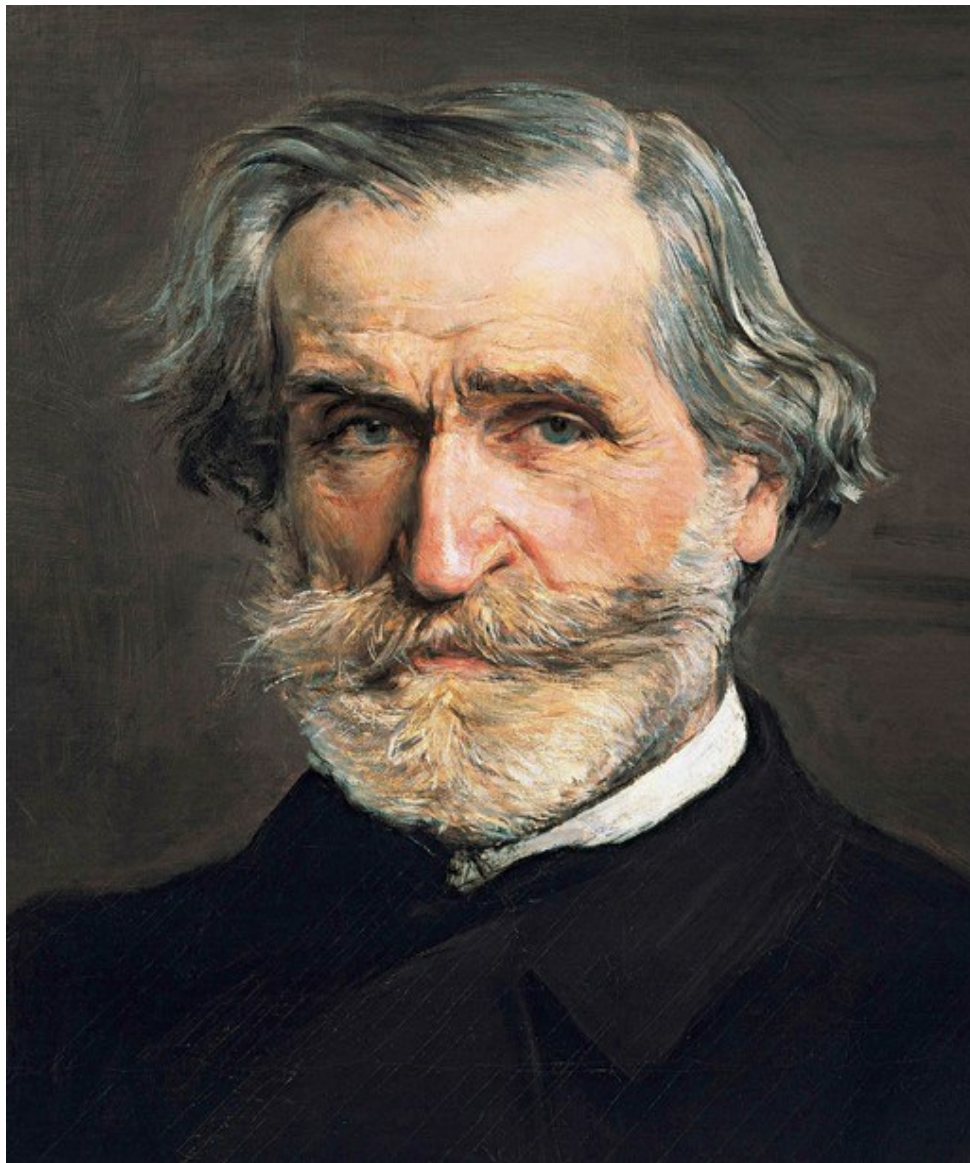




GIUSEPPE VERDI, 1886

Verdi commissioned this lively painting of himself from the fashionable Italian portraitist Giovanni Boldini. The composer introduced the artist to the milieu of opera, where he gained a substantial number of lucrative commissions.